

Facebook introduces 'Home' for Android!



Facebook has always ensured that it devises ways to keep people hooked on its mobile platform software.

Mark Zuckerberg, co-founder and chief executive, Facebook

This time, at an event in the US, the social networking site launched the much awaited Facebook Home for Android. It will change the main screen of the Android phone on which it is installed and will give users access to Facebook services.

Mark Zuckerberg, co-founder and chief executive, Facebook, has clearly stated that 'Home' is not a forked Android version; instead, the launcher will work right on top of current Android devices.

He further explained that Android's open source nature enables people to develop a custom user interface that will be loaded on the Android devices.

Home has been created for the purpose of offering a unique, people-centric 'homely' experience on Android devices, which has currently become more apps centric. There is no point in having a Facebook Phone, when Facebook Home itself can be used by a lot more Android users, Zuckerberg added.

In terms of features, Home comes with a new lock and home screens that will be based on one's Facebook page or profile. The new interface has apps like Cover Feed and Chat Heads, and offers a more personalised mobile experience. This means users will be able to go through Facebook content via Cover Feed, interact via SMS and Facebook messaging (with the Chat Heads app), and also dabble with the regular Android apps that would be installed on an Android device from Home's own app launcher.

Facebook Home will be available for selected devices like Samsung Galaxy S4, Galaxy S3, Galaxy Note 2, HTC One X, HTC One X+, and the recently launched HTC One smartphones for the time being; more devices will be added in the coming months.

Ubuntu 13.04 Linux better than Apple OS X 10.8.3?

Ubuntu 13.04 is typically known to be competitive with OS X 10.8.3, but new reports suggest that the Ubuntu 13.04 is actually outperforming Apple's operating system on its own MacBook hardware in some areas.

Fuduntu Linux reaches end-of-life!

Here is some bad news for Fuduntu lovers. Developers have announced that they are closing doors on this distro, finally.



Back in 2010, Fuduntu was built as a Fedora-based Linux distribution; however, it was forked soon afterwards. The project team explained that they have been trying to offer a desktop experience "somewhere between Fedora and Ubuntu." September 30, 2013, will be the last date for official support for the distro.

The news was announced via an official blog post by Lee Ward, project communications leader. He wrote, "No new features will be implemented. The only exceptions are those features which are already being worked on. We will continue to provide bug and security fixes until the last day of support, however. In addition to this, the move of the Linux world to systemd has caused a problem for Fuduntu as it has become a required thing for many programs, but we do not use it. Together with the GTK issue, Fuduntu has reached an impasse. To move forward would take quite a bit of time and manpower, neither of which can be supported.

"The team discussed several options and, ultimately, voted to end-of-life Fuduntu Linux. This decision was not made lightly but, ultimately, it was the best option. In its current state, Fuduntu would be broken if we tried to move forward."